

Start-up Visa Program

How to apply?

The program is designed to promote the establishment of start-ups and boost innovation in Latvia. It is a **temporary residence permit (TRP)**.

While not mandatory, but we suggest to send us a free-form description of the start-up idea at startup@liaa.gov.lv, before applying at OCMA, to check whether your idea qualifies for the visa.



Book an appointment (via phone or e-mail)

either Inside Latvia - through any OCMA division (list of all branches) **or** Outside Latvia - through the Consular Section of Latvian Embassy* (list of embassies and consulates)

**In case of applying outside of Latvia, call the respective embasst and learn about the process. While in general the process is similar, some details, timelines and fees may vary.*

Appointment Day - Submit Documents

Application Package:
- Valid passport (if you have multiple, bring all)
- **Fully** filled application for a residence permit
- 3x4 cm photo on a light background
- Proof of subsistence (bank statement) - 780 EUR * 12 months = 9360 EUR
- Free-form description of the start-up & detailed 3 year plan of commercial activities
- Statement about criminal records
- Proof of payment of the state fee

State Fee (paid by card or bank transfer):
- 30 days - 160 EUR
- 10 working days - 280 EUR
- 5 working days - 560 EUR

Important!
- TRP can be issued to max 5 foreign founders under the same start-up
- Need to have a valid Schengen visa for the whole application period
- OCMA can prolong the process if necesary (even if paid for fast-track)

Decision Letter from OCMA

OCMA will send you a decision letter (*Lēmums*) - if you have any difficulties understanding it, please contact us.

Upon positive decision OCMA will ask you to submit the following documents and biometric data:
- Annual health insurance policy
- Medical certificate confirming you don't have tuberculosis
- Proof of residence in Latvia (rent agreement on your name or statement of owner allowing you to live there)

How to Receive Your TRP?

Pay the State Fee (by card or bank transfer):
- 10 working days - 45 EUR
- 2 working days - 80 EUR

Pick Up Your TRP at OCMA by bringing:
- Decision Letter
- Passport

TRP is issued for max 3 years, but it needs to be renewed annually by submitting progress report to OCMA

Important Things to Remember:

TRP recipient is not allowed to be employed or be a member of the board of another company in Latvia. BUT being a shareholder is OK!

To keep your TRP valid:
- Be registered as a member of the board in a newly established company
- Within a year - attract an investment (>30k EUR from a VC fund or >15k EUR from an accelerator/business angel

OR

If you don't attract investment within a year, you shall submit your progress report. Committee will then decide whether to renew your TRP



Start-Up visas are regulated by Sections 23(1) 33) and 23(13) of Latvian Immigration Law

Investment and Development Agency of Latvia